Ransomware Response Checklist

Contain safely, preserve evidence and recover through a controlled plan.

First 15 minutes

- Report the event through the emergency contact path.
- Isolate affected devices from wired, wireless and VPN connections without powering them off unless safety requires it.
- Record visible messages, time, device name and the first observed symptoms.

Containment

- Disable compromised accounts and risky remote access after collecting essential evidence.
- Identify shared drives, backup systems and neighbouring systems that may be exposed.
- Block verified malicious indicators at appropriate controls and monitor for recurrence.

Evidence and decisions

- Preserve logs, memory and disk evidence using approved procedures.
- Track decisions, owners and timestamps in a central incident record.
- Engage legal, insurance, communications and law enforcement contacts according to policy.

Recovery

- Rebuild from known-good images and restore only verified clean data.
- Patch the entry point, rotate credentials and validate monitoring before reconnecting.
- Complete a lessons-learned review and update controls, backups and playbooks.

Use this guide with your organisation's policies and incident contacts. For urgent events, follow the approved escalation path immediately.